THAILAND CAVE RESCUE



In June 2018, twelve boys and their football coach decided to explore a large cave. [a] It was during the rainy season, so the ground was very wet and muddy. Unfortunately, the students lost their sense of direction while exploring, and rainwater began to fill the cave. When the students tried to exit the cave, they found that they had become trapped by the water.

Rescue workers quickly arrived; their first aim was to get oxygen to the boys. They achieved this by putting miles of pipes into the cave. Their efforts gained international attention. People from all over the world came to help. The surrounding jungle was turned into a makeshift town with food trucks and volunteer stations. The Thai military sent over one thousand men and women to help with the rescue, including the Royal Navy SEALs.

A world-famous cave-rescue team was brought in from Britain. A British diver and his colleague discovered footprints. They knew, then, that they were getting closer to finding the boys. [b] Unfortunately, the rains continued. These monsoon rains made the rescue effort even more of a challenge since volunteers had to pump billions of liters of water out of the cave.

After nine and a half days, the boys were found nearly three miles into the cave. All twelve boys and their coach were saved. The rescue was a success! Sadly, a former Royal Navy SEAL died during the rescue. His life will be forever celebrated. [c]

In the cave, the main challenge the boys had faced was finding enough food and water. They drank the clear water falling down from the rocks. They also had chips, sodas, and sugary drinks. The coach gave all his food to the children and taught them to meditate to save energy. They all held hands in the dark, keeping each other hopeful.

NOTE

Makeshift means something created to use for a short period of time, for a specific purpose.

Comprehension

5 Circle true or false.

1. The rescue team first aimed to get the children food. true false
2. The rain created a dangerous situation. true false
3. Over one thousand people came to try and rescue the boys. true false
4. Billions of liters of water had to be pumped out. true false
5. No one died during the rescue. true false

6 Read the statements. Where do they belong in the passage?

1. His colleagues will always remember him as a brave man. [a] [b] [c]
2. The boys had been on a bike ride after practice when they found the cave. [a] [b] [c]
3. Everyone began working quickly. [a] [b] [c]

Discussion

7 Read the questions. Talk with a partner.

1. Have you ever felt afraid?
2. Have you ever been inside a cave?
3. What are some problems the boys had? What are some solutions?

Challenge

8 Research the Thai cave rescue online. Draw a timeline of the re... paper. Then talk about what you could have done...